

Damián Vergara

CONTACT INFORMATION

✉ damiv@umich.edu
🌐 www.damianvergara.com

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Assistant Professor, Department of Economics, University of Michigan
Postdoctoral Research Associate, Industrial Relations Section, Princeton University

2024-
2023-2024

AFFILIATIONS

Faculty Research Fellow, NBER (Public Economics)
Research Affiliate, IZA Institute of Labor Economics

2025-
2023-

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics, UC Berkeley
M.A. in Economics, Universidad de Chile
B.A. in Business and Economics, Universidad de Chile

2023
2016
2013

TEACHING

At the University of Michigan: Graduate Public Economics (Fall 2024, Winter 2026, Fall 2026), Undergraduate Public Economics (Winter 2025, Winter 2026, Fall 2026)

REFEREED PUBLICATIONS

[Place-Based Redistribution](#)
with C. Gaubert, P. Kline, and D. Yagan, [American Economic Review](#), vol. 115(10), 3415-3450, 2025

[Workplace Litigiousness and Labor Market Outcomes: Evidence from a Workers' Compensation Reform](#)
with M. Lauletta, [Journal of Law and Economics](#), vol. 69(4), 933-956, 2025

[Do Policies and Institutions Matter for Pre-Tax Income Inequality? Cross-Country Evidence](#)
[International Tax and Public Finance](#), vol. 29(1), 20-52, 2022

[Combining Discrimination Diagnostics to Identify Sources of Statistical Discrimination](#)
with P. Domínguez and N. Grau, [Economics Letters](#), vol. 212, 110294, 2022

[Ambiguity and Long-Run Cooperation in Strategic Games](#)
with M. Rojas, [Oxford Economic Papers](#), vol. 73(3), 1077-1098, 2021

[Using Small Businesses for Individual Tax Planning: Evidence from Special Tax Regimes in Chile](#)
with C. Agostini, E. Engel, and A. Repetto, [International Tax and Public Finance](#), vol. 25(6), 1449-1489, 2018

WORKING PAPERS

[A Sufficient Statistics Approach to Optimal Corporate Taxes](#)
with D. Swonder, R&R at [Journal of Political Economy](#)

[Minimum Wages and Optimal Redistribution: The Role of Firm Profits](#)

[Minimum Wages and the Distribution of Firm Wage Premia](#)
with M. Bergolo, R. Ceni, and M. Fondo

[Directed Search, Pay, and Non-Wage Amenities: Evidence from an Online Job Board](#)
with V. Escudero and H. Liepmann

[Optimal Tax Information with Privacy Concerns](#)
with J. Slemrod, Accepted at [International Tax and Public Finance](#)

[An Observational Implementation of the Outcome Test with an Application to Ethnic Prejudice in Pretrial Detentions](#)
with N. Grau, R&R at [Journal of the European Economic Association](#)

[Discrimination Against Immigrants in the Criminal Justice System: Evidence from Pretrial Detentions](#)
with P. Domínguez and N. Grau

SELECTED WORK IN PROGRESS	Equality of Opportunity vs Equality of Outcomes: A Theory of Optimal Predistribution with R. Chetty, H. Kleven, and D. Yagan
	Optimal Labor Inspections with S. Correa and P. Muñoz
	An Anatomy of Wage Spillovers: Evidence from an Occupation-Industry-Specific Wage Floor with J. Feinmann and R. Hsu Rocha
NON-REFEREED PUBLICATIONS	A Simple Model of Corporate Tax Incidence with D. Swonder, <u>AEA Papers and Proceedings</u> 114, 352-357, 2024
	Trends in US Spatial Inequality: Concentrating Affluence and a Democratization of Poverty with C. Gaubert, P. Kline, and D. Yagan, <u>AEA Papers and Proceedings</u> , vol. 111, 520-525, 2021
PRE-DOCTORAL RESEARCH AND POLICY PAPERS	Diagnóstico Distributivo de Ingreso y Patrimonio, y Análisis de la Propuesta de Reforma Tributaria en Materia de Renta y Riqueza (in Spanish) with N. Bohme, I. Flores, P. Gutiérrez, R. Smith, and P. Valenzuela, <u>Ministry of Finance Report, Chile</u> , 2022
	Natural Resources and Educational Attainment: Evidence from Chile with R. Álvarez, <u>Resources Policy</u> , vol. 76, 102573, 2022
	Análisis de la Implementación de las Nuevas Reglas de Financiamiento a la Política y Campañas Electorales (in Spanish, with E. Engel, M. Jaraquemada, and N. Campos). <u>Informe de Políticas Públicas, Espacio Público</u> , 2018
	Principios para una Reforma al Sistema de Pensiones (in Spanish) with E. Engel, E. Fajnzylber, P. Fernández, S. Gray, and A. Repetto, <u>Informe de Políticas Públicas, Espacio Público</u> , 2017
	Sistema de Pensiones: Opiniones y Demandas Ciudadanas (in Spanish) <u>Documento de Referencia, Espacio Público</u> , 2017
BOOK CHAPTERS	Cómo Diseñar Impuestos: Teoría Económica y Evidencia Empírica (in Spanish) In <u>Impuestos Justos para el Chile que Viene</u> , edited by J. Atria and C. Otero, FCE, Chile
AWARDS, HONORS, AND FELLOWSHIPS	2025 Fondo de Evaluación de Impacto, Grant, DIPRES, Gobierno de Chile 2022 O-Lab Initiative on Racial Equity in the Labor Market, Fellowship, UC Berkeley 2021-2022 Law, Economics, and Politics Center (LEAP), Fellowship, UC Berkeley 2021 Center of Equitable Growth (CEG), Fellowship, UC Berkeley 2021 Strandberg Fund for Gender Equity in Economics, Grant, UC Berkeley 2020 Burch Center, Fellowship, UC Berkeley 2019 Institute of International Studies (IIS), Grant, UC Berkeley 2017 Lindau Nobel Laureate Meetings in Economic Sciences (selected participant), Lindau, Germany 2016 Best Student of Class, M.A. in Economics, Universidad de Chile 2015 Chilean Engineers Association Award to the best undergraduate students 2014-2015 Scientific Chilean Council (CONICYT), Fellowship for Master Studies, Chile 2014 Top 1% of Class, B.A. in Economics, Universidad de Chile
SEMINARS AND CONFERENCES (SCHEDULED *)	2026 ASU Empirical Microeconomics Conference, UCSD, IIPF Annual Congress* 2025 University of Michigan, PUC Chile, IMD Days (Warsaw), NBER Economic Analysis of Business Taxation Fall Meeting, Bocconi Workshop on Labor Markets and Public Policy, CMU (Tepper), NTA 118th Annual Conference, UCL 2024 ASSA Annual Meetings, Columbia Junior Micro-Macro Labor Conference, Princeton University, APEX Workshop (Australian National University), 7th Junior Applied Micro Conference (EIEF), Princeton Global Minimum Wages Conference, University of Michigan, 3rd M-NEW Annual Workshop (PUC Chile), Universidad de Chile 2023 Bocconi University, OECD (CFE and ELS/JAI), Yale University, Princeton University, University of Chicago (Booth and Harris), Northwestern University, University of Michigan, UCLA, LEAP Conference (Berkeley), IIPF Annual Congress, GRAPE-IMD Seminar, Brookings Economic Studies, Universidad de Chile 2022 Universidad Adolfo Ibáñez, UC Berkeley, Universidad de la República de Uruguay, OPFS Workshop for Graduate Students, O-Lab Workshop for Graduate Students, LMF Job Market Workshop

	2021 UC Berkeley, LACEA Workshop on the Economics of Crime, RIDGE Workshop on Public Economics, NTA 114th Annual Conference												
	2020 UC Berkeley, Universidad de Chile												
	2017 NTA 110th Annual Conference												
	2016 16th SAET Conference, Universidad de Chile, Chilean Economists Association (SECHI) Annual Meetings, LACEA-LAMES Annual Meetings												
PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES	Referee at: American Economic Journal: Economic Policy, American Economic Review, American Economic Review: Insights, Applied Economic Letters, Econometrica, Economic Journal, ILR Review, Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization, Journal of Economic Inequality, Journal of Labor Economics, Journal of Money Credit and Banking, Journal of Political Economy, Journal of Public Economics, Journal of Regional Science, Journal of Urban Economics, Quarterly Journal of Economics, Review of Economics and Statistics, Structural Change and Economic Dynamics Coorganizer of: North-East Labor Symposium NELS (2024, Princeton), NBER Public Economics Spring Meeting (2026) Scientific committee of: National Tax Association Annual Conference (2025, 2026)												
GRADUATE ADVISING (DISSERTATION COMMITTEE)	Graduation year and initial placement in parenthesis: Ana Paula Franco (2026, Minneapolis Fed Postdoc, University of Manchester AP), Luciana Galeano (2026, Revelio Labs), Thomas Lloyd (2026, EM Lyon Business School AP), Eva Wang (2026, Charles River Associates)												
OTHER PROFESSIONAL AND RESEARCH EXPERIENCE	<table> <tr> <td>Tax Policy Advisor, Ministry of Finance, Chile</td><td>2022</td></tr> <tr> <td>Research Assistant, Department of Economics, UC Berkeley</td><td>2018-2020</td></tr> <tr> <td>Researcher, Espacio Público, Santiago, Chile</td><td>2016-2017</td></tr> <tr> <td>Research Assistant, Department of Economics, Universidad de Chile, Santiago, Chile</td><td>2012-2016</td></tr> <tr> <td>Research Assistant, Chilean Antitrust Agency, Santiago, Chile</td><td>2012-2013</td></tr> <tr> <td>Research Assistant, ECLAC, Economic Development Department, Santiago, Chile</td><td>2010-2011</td></tr> </table>	Tax Policy Advisor, Ministry of Finance, Chile	2022	Research Assistant, Department of Economics, UC Berkeley	2018-2020	Researcher, Espacio Público, Santiago, Chile	2016-2017	Research Assistant, Department of Economics, Universidad de Chile, Santiago, Chile	2012-2016	Research Assistant, Chilean Antitrust Agency, Santiago, Chile	2012-2013	Research Assistant, ECLAC, Economic Development Department, Santiago, Chile	2010-2011
Tax Policy Advisor, Ministry of Finance, Chile	2022												
Research Assistant, Department of Economics, UC Berkeley	2018-2020												
Researcher, Espacio Público, Santiago, Chile	2016-2017												
Research Assistant, Department of Economics, Universidad de Chile, Santiago, Chile	2012-2016												
Research Assistant, Chilean Antitrust Agency, Santiago, Chile	2012-2013												
Research Assistant, ECLAC, Economic Development Department, Santiago, Chile	2010-2011												
OTHER	Languages: Spanish (native), English (fluent) Citizenship: Chilean												

Last update: June 2026